

Nine Things You Must Know about Alfresco, an Open Source ECM System

Alfresco is a leading open source based enterprise content management system. This article introduces readers to Alfresco, and highlights its key features that would benefit business users, technical architects and developers.



With so much content generated each day, going paperless has become an important goal for every organisation. This ever evolving content surely needs to have a robust, scalable, easy-to-use, secured and powerful content management system (CMS) to make it easy to capture, store, manage, preserve and deliver the content on demand. When it comes to enterprise content management (ECM), the range of options is wide and includes proprietary solutions as well as open source implementations. However, open source and open standard based ECM alternatives seem to be the preferred choice of organisations rather than the closed source or proprietary counterparts.

Alfresco is a leading open source based ECM that's been available in the market since a decade now, helping enterprises maximise the value of their content by providing the content management solutions with an open source and open standards based technology stack. Because it is easy to customise and extend, as well as to integrate with other applications, Alfresco is a preferred choice as an open source enterprise ECM for

business users, technical architects and developer groups.

Alfresco is available in three different flavours—the Alfresco One enterprise edition, the Alfresco Community Edition and Alfresco in the Cloud. Alfresco One is an enterprise-ready, fully tested edition. It is fully supported by Alfresco and provides additional capabilities such as high availability, analytics and so on. It is ideal for organisations looking for an ECM with enterprise level scalability, high availability and full support from the ECM vendor. Alfresco in the Cloud is a SaaS based edition of Alfresco One (without additional Alfresco One modules). It is ideal for smaller teams, which are distributed at multiple locations, and avoids the hassle of managing the servers on the premises.

Alfresco Community Edition includes community driven development and contributions. It is developed and maintained by Alfresco with the help of Alfresco Community members across the world. The Alfresco product engineering team periodically does provide fully stable releases of the Alfresco Community Edition. Small to medium businesses